Pneumatology: The Doctrine of the Holy Spirit

Week -3



Titles of the Holy Spirit

- The Holy Spirit one of the persons of the Trinity.
- He is known by many names and titles, most of which denote some function or aspect of His ministry.
- Doctrine of the Holy Spirit is to start by noticing the names or the descriptive titles
- New Testament attributes numerous titles to the Holy Spirit reflecting its **roles, attributes, and relationship with the Holy Trinity.**



Holy Spirit

The Bible uses the title “Holy Spirit” most often when referring to God’s Spirit.

- In essence, God is Spirit (Jn 4:24).
- one of His fundamental characteristics is holiness (Lev 11:44; Jn 17:11), and the title “Holy Spirit” reflects this.
- Nebuchadnezzar, an ancient Babylonian king, testified to the holy nature of God by calling the Holy Spirit the “Spirit of the Holy God” (Dan 4:8, 9, 18).
- In the same way, the apostle Paul called Him the “Spirit of holiness” (Rom 1:4).



Paraclete/ጰራቅሊጦስ/

Derived from Greek word (παράκλητος) Meaning "Advocate" emphasizing the Spirit's role as a guide and *"Comforter" or "Counselor"* (as found in John 14:16, 26; 15:26; and 16:7).

- The term *parakletos* is found five times in the Bible, always in the **Johannine writings** (Jn 14:16, 26; 15:26; 16:7; 1 Jn 2:1)
- Counselor, or Paraclete, is another name for the Holy Spirit, the third Person of Holy Spirit who among other things provides guidance, consolation, strength, and support to people.
- As a comforter, the Holy Spirit has the mission to comfort (Acts 9:31).
- As a teacher, the Holy Spirit enables believers to understand the truth (1 Jn 2:27).
- As one who empowers, the Holy Spirit gives power to believers to witness for Christ (Acts 2:4, 14–36; 4:19–20, 31).
- As a witness, the Holy Spirit testifies for Jesus Christ and counsels Christians in their witness for Him (Mk 13:11; Lk 12:11–12).

In general, parakletos conveys the diverse roles of the Holy Spirit as comforter, teacher, helper, witness, one who empowers, and one who convicts.



Names & Titles



The Comforter

The Holy Spirit is referred to as "The Comforter," emphasizing His role in providing guidance, assurance, and peace to believers as they navigate their faith journey.

The Advocate

As "The Advocate," the Holy Spirit intercedes on behalf of believers, speaking to God for them and helping them in their weaknesses and spiritual struggles.

The Spirit of Truth

Known as "The Spirit of Truth," He reveals divine truths, guiding the faithful in understanding God's Word and applying it in their lives with wisdom and discernment.

The Gift

The Holy Spirit is called "The Gift," representing God's grace bestowed upon believers, empowering them for service and enriching their spiritual lives with His presence and gifts.

Names & Titles



The Spirit

He is the Spirit of God and the Spirit of His Son as well (Gal. 4:6),

- ✓ He is called the Spirit, according to the Scripture just now read, “For to one is given by the Spirit the word of wisdom.” [1 Cor. 12:8]
- ✓ as it is written, “And I saw the Spirit of God descending” [John 1:32];
- ✓ “For as many as are led by the Spirit of God, they are the sons of God.” [Rom. 8:14].

The Spirit of the Father

As the Savior says, “For it is not you that speak, but the Spirit of your Father which speaks in you;” [Matt. 10:20]

- ✓ Paul says, “For this reason I bow my knees to the Father. of our Lord Jesus Christ…that He would grant you…to be strengthened with might through His Holy Spirit.” [Ephes. 3:14-16].

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The Spirit of the Lord,

Peter spoke, “Why is it that you have agreed together to tempt the Spirit of the Lord?” [Acts 5:9]. He is called also the Spirit of God and Christ,

- ✓ as Paul writes, “But you are not in the flesh, but in the Spirit, if so be that the Spirit of God dwell in you. But if any man have not the Spirit of Christ, he is none of His.” [Rom. 8:9].

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The Spirit of the Son of God,

As it is said, “And because you are sons, God has sent forth the Spirit of His Son.” [Gal. 4:6].

- ✓ He is called also the Spirit of Christ, as it is written, “Searching what or what manner of time the Spirit of Christ which was in them did signify;” [1 Pet. 1:11]
- ✓ “Through your prayer, and the supply of the Spirit of Jesus Christ.” [Phil. 1:19]..

Names & Titles

Spirit of Truth

(Jn. 14:17), “When He, the Spirit of Truth, has come; He will guide you into all truth…” (Jn. 16:13).

- ✓ Bible tells us that Jesus is the truth (Jn 14:6), and that the Holy Spirit is truth (1 Jn 5:6). And as Jesus’ Spirit is the Holy Spirit (2 Cor 3:17), the Holy Spirit is also the Spirit of truth.
- ✓ Therefore, when Jesus spoke of the Holy Spirit, He referred to Him as the “Spirit of truth” (Jn 14:17; 15:26; 16:13).
- ✓ In the same way, Apostle John wrote about the “spirit of truth”, whom he contrasted with the “spirit of error” (1 Jn 4:6).
- ✓ Holy Spirit has the mission of bearing witness for the Lord Jesus (Jn 15:26). Since Jesus embodies the essence of truth, the Holy Spirit testifies of Jesus and the truth.

Spirit of wisdom and revelation

In Ephesians 1:17, the Holy Spirit is called the “spirit of wisdom and revelation”. This is because He gives wisdom and reveals God’s hidden purposes.

- ✓ By God’s Spirit and wisdom, Joseph interpreted Pharaoh’s dreams which predicted God’s future plans for Egypt. As a result of the interpretation, Pharaoh set Joseph over Egypt as his prime minister (Gen 41:37–41). After Moses laid hands on him, Joshua was filled with the Spirit of wisdom to lead the Israelites into Canaan (Deut).
- ✓ In 1 Corinthians 2:11, Paul writes: “For what man knows the things of a man except the spirit of the man which is in him? Even so no one knows the things of God except the Spirit of God.” 34:9).

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Theology concerning Holy Spirit (Scriptures)

In the Orthodox understanding, Old Testament. ***Ruah d' Elohim (Spirit of God)*** is mainly understood as the source of all charisms and as an agent of communication, which mediates between God and man.

- The Spirit of God plays a significant role right from the creation of the Cosmos.
- The Spirit has also got a unique role in the life of Israel.
- It is considered to be the source of all the ministries and charisms of Israel.
- The Spirit is considered to be the agent, which keeps the human-divine relationship and creaturely dependence of man upon God.
- In Psalms the Spirit is rendered as the divine presence in the human beings (Ps 51:10-12).
- Different rabbinic schools have their own interpretations of the Old Testament.

✓ The working of the Spirit of God is a prominent theme in their literature.

✓ They have developed their Pneumatology in the light of the Old Testament.

❖ To a great extent their ideas influenced the formation of the Christian Pneumatology.



God is Father Son and Holy Spirit. The Trinitarian formula of Baptism introduced by…

- Jesus Christ (Mtt. 28.19) reveals the co-equality, co-essentiality, co-divinity of father son and Holy Spirit.
- The Baptism of Christ manifested the mystery of this Holy Trinity (Mtt. 3.13-17)
- but even before that event numerous old testament references pointed to the Trinity (Gen.1.26,18.1-16,1s.6.1-4)
- They all suggest one God in three persons, the father, Son and the Holy spirit.

Thus the term 'Trinity' is not a metaphysical one. it is only a designation of the the facts.

1. The Father is God ; 2. the Son is God; 3. the Spirit is God; 4. Three but one God.

Our concern here is to describe the Doctrine of the Holy Spirit.



The Holy Spirit as the Source of Life/Creation

The Spirit had its unique role in the creation of cosmos and humanity. The Spirit of God is present at the very beginning of creation, hovering over the waters.

- In (Genesis 1:2) we read, "The earth was formless and empty, and darkness covered the deep waters. And the Spirit of God was hovering over the surface of the waters."
- The Spirit's presence at creation signifies His active role in bringing order out of chaos.
- **Hovering**-Just as a hen broods over her eggs for the purpose of producing them and bringing forth new life, so the Holy Spirit brooded over the original creation of God for the purpose of filling its void with life in various forms.
- This is about the work of the Holy Spirit over the primeval chaotic water.
- Spirit of God is a creative agent, which worked together with the Word of God to bring forth meaningful existence from the lifeless chaos.
- By the Word and the Spirit, God created life and light and drew the cosmos out of chaos.



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- ቅዱስ ባስልዮስም *“የመንፈስ ቅዱስን ፈጣሪነት ሲያመጣ “የእግዚአብሔር መንፈስ በውኃ ላይ ሰፍፎ ነበር ብሎ ጻፈ” በማለት መስክሯል።*
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- ሶርያዊ አባት ቅዱስ ኤፍሬም “መንፈስ ቅዱስ የወረደው የመፍጠር ሥራ ከአብ እና ከወልድ ጋር ያከናወኑት ተግባር የመሆኑን ምሥጢር እንዲገልጽልን ነው” ይላል። **አብ ተናገረ ፤ ወልድ ፈጠረ፤ መንፈስ ቅዱስም ሥራውን ያስማማ ዘንድ ወረደ።** *ከሁለቱም ከአብ እና ከወልድ ጋር አንድ መሆኑን ያሰማ ዘንድ። በዚህም ሁሉ የመጣው በሥላሴ ሥራ እንደሆነ እንረዳለን” በማለት መንፈስ ቅዱስ በመፍጠር ከአብ እና ከወልድ ጋራ አንድ መሆኑ ያስረዳል።*

- **የቅዱስ ዳዊት “በእግዚአብሔር ቃል ሰማዮች ጸኑ፤ሠራዊቶቻቸውም ሁሉ በአፉ እስትንፋስ” (መዝ.3÷6) የሚለው የመዝሙር ክፍል ሲሆን ይህም መንፈስ ቅዱስ በማይ ላይ በመስፈፉ ዓለምን እንዳጸና እና የሰማይ ሠራዊት የጸኑት (የተገኙ) - በአብ በወልድ በመንፈስ ቅዱስ አምላካዊ ሥልጣን መሆኑን አመላካች ነው።።(ነገረ መንፈስ ቅዱስ፤ ዲን ልሳነ ጽድቅ ኪዳነ፤ ገጽ 82)**

Presence and work of the Holy Spirit in Human being is a major theme in the Old Testament.

- In the second creation story the Spirit is depicted as the unique life principle in Man. In Gen.2:7 it is stated: *“Then the Lord God formed man of dust from the ground and breathed into the nostrils the breath of life; and man became a living being”*.
- “then the Lord said, “My Spirit shall not abide in man forever, for he is flesh, but his days shall be hundred and twenty years”.

- Gen.2:7 describe a twofold relationship of man. Man is made out of the earth-matter and has his roots with the rest of the materiel creation. But God breathed into man the spark of divinity.
- By that very divine act man became uplifted to a realm higher to that of the animals



- “የፈጠረኝ የእግዚአብሔር መንፈስ ነው፤ ሕይወትንም የሰጠኝ ሁሉን የሚችል የአምላክ እስትንፋስ ነው” (ኢዮ.33÷4)
- “እስትንፋስ ስትሰጣቸው ይፈጠራሉ” (መዝ.104÷30) የሚሉትን ክፍሎች ስንመለከት መንፈስ ቅዱስ ሕይወትን የሚሰጥ ፍጥረትን ያስገኘ ፈጣሪ÷ ገባሪ (ሠሪ) ÷ ሕያው አምላክ መሆኑን የሚያመለክት ነው ።(ነገረ መንፈስ ቅዱስ፤ ዲን ልሳነ ጽድቅ ኪዳነ፤ ገጽ 82)

A theological distinction between spirit (Ruah) and soul (psyche). "psyche" (Greek: ψυχή), often translated as "soul." refers to the immaterial essence of a human being, encompassing the mind, will, and emotions.

- The Ruah in humans began to represent the God- ward direction of human existence, emphasizing humanity's connection to the divine..
- In Orthodox theology, the soul is seen as the life-principle breathed into humanity by God, reflecting the divine image and designed for eternal communion with Him (Genesis 2:7).
- The soul's well-being is nurtured through prayer, repentance, and participation in the sacraments, as it seeks to grow in holiness and align with God's will.



Spirit of God in the Community of Israel

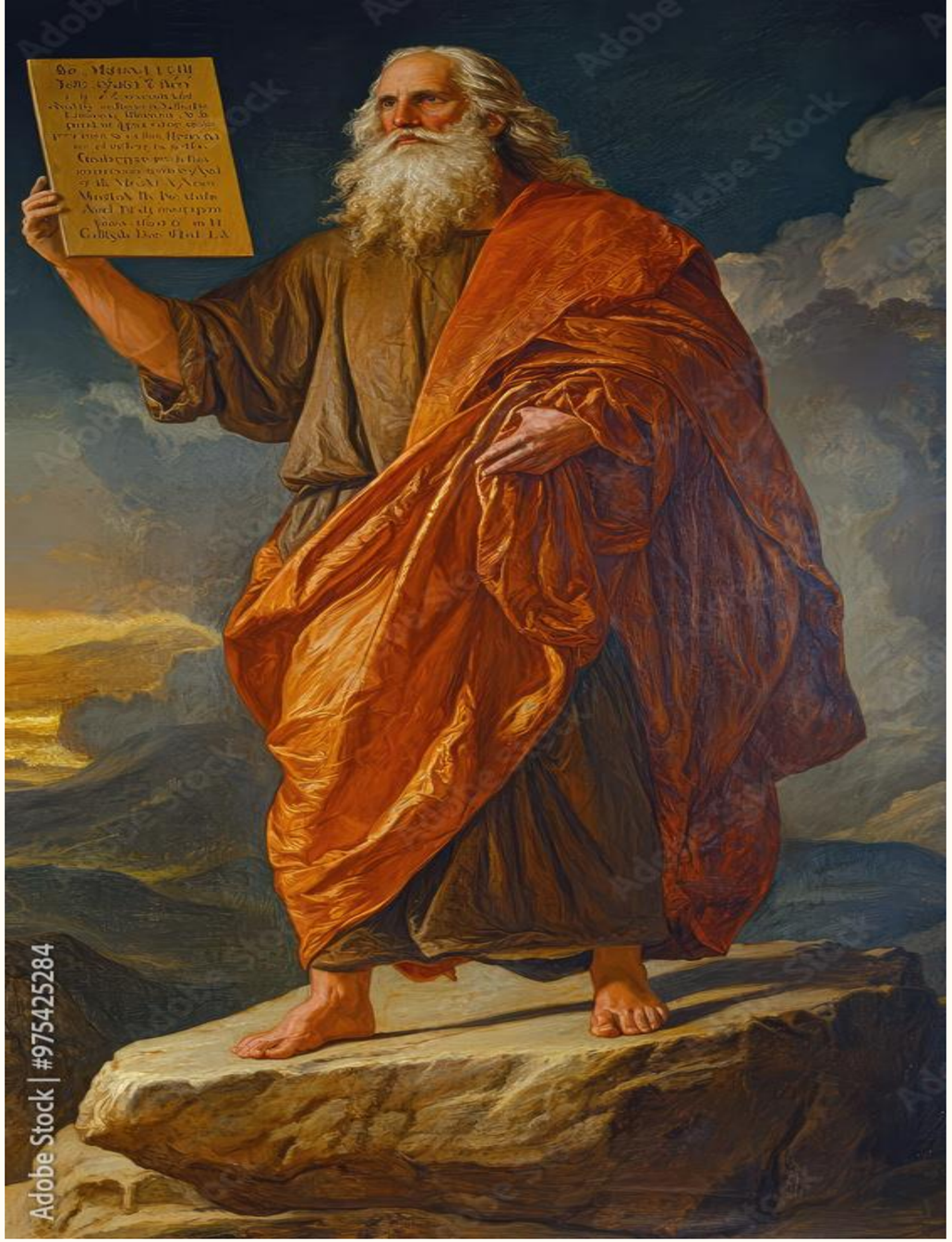
In the Old Testament, the Spirit of God acts as a medium and instrument of divine intervention in the history of Israel.

- ✓ For the people of the Old Testament, the Spirit of God was the source of all **charismas** including **leadership, prophecy and all creative skills**.

Holy Spirit in Prophecy

Spirit of God is considered to be the source of genuine prophecy.

- Spirit communicated the will of God to Israel through the prophets.
- Close association between 'Spirit of God' and prophecy was a matter of great concern to the Rabbinic thought.
- expressions 'Spirit of God' and 'Spirit of Prophecy' are used almost like synonyms here.
- For them the 'Spirit of God' is the source of all types of revelations. The prophets are conscious about their possession of the Spirit. They consider themselves as the Spirit-filled messengers of Yahweh. Hosea equates the prophet with the man of Spirit (9:7).



Holy Spirit in Prophecy

- The Spirit played a vital role in the lives of prophets and leaders empowering them to communicate divine truth and love. Isaiah 61:1
- Spirit anointing the Messiah to preach good news, while Psalm 51:11 reflects King David's plea not to lose the Spirit's presence.
- The Spirit's activity aimed at fostering moral purity and holiness (Isaiah 11:2; 42:1).

❖ Holy Spirit in the Old Testament descended upon the prophets, upon some kings making them prophesy and praise God, like with David.

✓ To some He gave gifts like Samson’s strength or Solomon’s wisdom.

✓ prophets spoke through the Holy Spirit, “for prophecy never came by the will of man, but holy men of God spoke as they were moved by the Holy Spirit” (2Pet 1:21).



Holy Spirit in Kingship

Anointing makes clear the continuing work of the Spirit in the office of the king.

- Spirit of Lord remain as the source of authority in Israel.
- anointing of David by Samuel is narrated in 1 Sam. 16:13: "Then Samuel took the horn of oil, and anointed him (David) in the midst of his brothers; and the Spirit of the Lord came mightily upon David from that day forward".

✓ David's reception of the Spirit of God resulting from the anointing by Samuel, Saul lost the Spirit in him.

✓ when he heard Goliath defying the very armies of the living God, the Holy Spirit moved within him.

✓ His Zeal was a fire that he could not bear.

❖ However, in the Old Testament these descents were not for all the believers and were temporary, like with King Saul, whereas in the New Testament we became temples of the Holy Spirit and He dwells in us.



Spirit in the Psalms

Psalms witness different characteristics and functions of the Spirit as the ***life-giving agent in creation and as the source of moral guidance, inner renewal, God's active presence***, etc.

- Ps. 33:4 presents the Spirit (breath) as an agent of creation
- Ps. 104: 30 He is the one who preserves and renew the earth. For the Psalmist Spirit manifests the presence of God (Ps.139:7).
- Spirit of God works also as a guide and renovator of each human person (Ps.143:10; 51:12-14).

❖ Picture of the Spirit in Psalms is fairly different from that of the early books and prophetic tradition, which depict the Spirit as the source of ***ecstatic and visionary experience.***

✓ Role of the Spirit in the realm of personal experience is treated with importance.

✓ Ps.51 the Spirit is pictured as s***omething divine, a gift of God in man.*** In vs. 10 the **Psalmist cries for a new Spirit**. In vs.11 the preservation of the Holy Spirit is demanded. Here the **Spirit is serving as the Divine-human link.**

✓ Spirit as the guide and renovator is very close to the New Testament concept of Holy Spirit, especially that of the Johannine **'Paraclete'.**



The Holy Spirit and Wisdom

Devout individuals in the Old Testament experienced the Holy Spirit as the source of spiritual understanding, wisdom, and knowledge.

- Ecclesiasticus (Sirach) 39:6 highlights the Spirit's role in granting insight, **while the Wisdom literature (Wisdom 7:7; 9:17)** attributes the pursuit of wisdom and religious knowledge to the Spirit's inspiration.

❖ Old Testament illustration of the Holy Spirit highlights

✓ its integral role in **creation, divine communication, moral guidance, and spiritual renewal.**

✓ Spirit's presence bridges the **natural and supernatural, enabling humanity to align with God's will and partake in His holiness**. This foundation sets the stage for the fuller revelation of the Holy Spirit in the New Testament.

